

# Missing and Unbalanced Examples

Project: Helpful Classroom Sorter

## 1. Your mission

### Your learning target

I can name the target collection, selection list and cases actually assessed.

I can use a coverage table to identify missing conditions before making a claim.

I can propose a selection plan that addresses a stated gap without promising certainty.

### Remember before reading

Close your notes first. A rough first answer helps us choose the right starting point; it is not a score for your ability.

Without opening the old lesson, explain one key idea from Good Data, Bad Data. Give an example and a mistake that the idea helps you avoid.

Without opening the old lesson, explain one key idea from Similarity. Give an example and a mistake that the idea helps you avoid.

Without opening the old lesson, explain one key idea from Boundaries and 'Not Sure'. Give an example and a mistake that the idea helps you avoid.

After trying, check the relevant lesson or ask your teacher. Change the part of your explanation that the evidence shows was wrong.

What is absent can shape a system's failures.



LEARNING TARGET A training set has 18 daylight photos and two dark photos of one object. Copying the dark photos eight times balances the counts. Does it balance the variety? Design a better collection step.

Learner name:

### Readiness for the connected explanation

A table has been checked and every recorded value matches its source. Does that prove it includes all the conditions in which a system will be used? Explain.

### This week's end goal

By the end, I can identify missing conditions and design a targeted coverage check.

## 2. Notice the evidence

PICTURE STORY

### Look Closely Before You Explain

Pictures give clues; evidence tells us what the clues mean.



**MYSTERY** An animal recognizer trained only on bright daytime photos may fail on the same animals at night.

### What do you notice?

Name three visible details without explaining them yet.

Circle the detail most connected to the system's decision.

Name one detail that may be decoration or distraction.

Make a first prediction and state the clue that supports it.

My observations, prediction, and evidence:

**GOOD THINKING** A prediction can change when stronger evidence appears.

### A closer explanation

Suppose a shape recogniser will be evaluated on a fixed collection of 24 invented picture cards. This target population has 6 bright circles, 6 dim circles, 6 bright squares and 6 dim squares. Each card has its own ID and an independently checked circle or square label. We want to know how often the recogniser gives the correct label across these 24 cards.

A tester takes the 6 bright-circle cards nearest the front of the box. Those 6 cards form the sample; the other 18 have not been assessed. The recogniser is correct on 5 of the 6 sampled cards. That is a result for these assessed bright circles. It does not establish correctness on the squares or dim cards.

A sampling frame is the list or source available for selection. A complete list of all 24 IDs could give every card a chance of selection. A list containing only bright-circle IDs cannot select dim cards or squares, even

if the choice from that list is random. These fictional picture cards do not contain personal information.

### 3. See how it works

VISUAL MECHANISM

**Input** → **Process** → **Output**

Follow the information instead of imagining magic inside the machine.



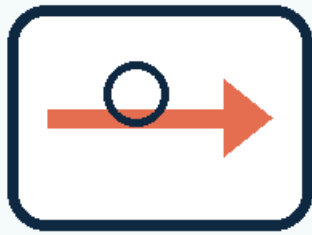
**INPUT**

example set with represented and absent conditions



**PROCESS**

learn patterns from available coverage



## OUTPUT

uneven performance across conditions

INPUT example set with represented and absent conditions

PROCESS learn patterns from available coverage

OUTPUT uneven performance across conditions

CORE IDEA What is absent can shape a system's failures.

UNDER THE HOOD Sampling imbalance changes the empirical distribution seen during training. Missing subgroups or conditions cannot contribute error signals, so average success may hide systematic failure. Rebalancing requires relevant examples, not arbitrary duplication alone.

Draw a fresh example with all three stages:

### A closer explanation

#### Coverage is about cases as well as counts

**Card condition · Target count · Assessed count**

**Card condition:** Bright circles

**Target count:** 6 cards

**Assessed count:** 6 assessed

---

**Card condition:** Dim circles

**Target count:** 6 cards

**Assessed count:** 0 assessed

---

**Card condition:** Bright squares

**Target count:** 6 cards

**Assessed count:** 0 assessed

---

**Card condition:** Dim squares

**Target count:** 6 cards

**Assessed count:** 0 assessed

---

All 6 assessed cases come from one of four conditions. An assessed count of zero means no evidence for that condition; it does not mean the recogniser failed every case in it.

The target has 24 distinct cards, but the sample covers only the 6 bright circles. Photographing each sampled card twice would create 12 image records without adding a new card or covering a missing condition. Record the identity of the underlying case as well as the number of files.

Both shape and lighting matter to this question. A sample with bright circles and dim squares includes each shape and each lighting label, yet still misses dim circles and bright squares. Check combinations when the interaction could matter, not just whether each individual label appears somewhere.

### Connect the picture and the explanation

Point to the input, the deciding step and the result in this week's visual. Explain the same step in ordinary words. A picture helps when you can say what each part represents.

## 4. Compare the cases

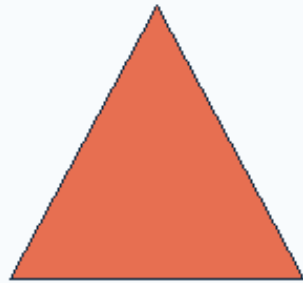
PICTURE GALLERY

### Four Cases, Four Clues

Use the visual cue, then read the evidence carefully.



**Day photos**



**Night photos**



**Cats 90, dogs 10**



**One dog copied 20 times**

CASE 1 — Day photos Clue: many clear examples. Meaning: strong represented condition.

CASE 2 — Night photos Clue: none available. Meaning: coverage gap.

CASE 3 — Cats 90, dogs 10 Clue: uneven class counts. Meaning: class imbalance.

CASE 4 — One dog copied 20 times Clue: count rises, variety does not. Meaning: weak repair.

BOUNDARY Balance is about useful representation, not forcing every count to be identical without reason.

Which two pictures are easiest to confuse? What evidence separates them?

## Change one thing in the pictured case

Change: Add eight more bright plain cards and no dim cards.

Prediction: The sample becomes larger but still has no dim coverage.

Reason: The missing lighting condition remains untested.

## 5. Words that unlock the idea

### VOCABULARY

#### Words You Can See and Use

The badge is a memory cue; the definition does the real thinking work.





**imbalance**



**subgroup**



### Word · Meaning · My example

**Word:** missing example

**Meaning:** needed condition absent from data

**My example:** \_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

**Word:** imbalance

**Meaning:** some groups appear much more than others

**My example:** \_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

**Word:** subgroup

**Meaning:** defined part of the intended population

**My example:** \_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

**Word:** coverage gap

**Meaning:** important situation poorly represented

**My example:** \_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

### Misconception detective

CLAIM TO REPAIR A model can infer missing conditions automatically.

Use one vocabulary word and one piece of evidence to repair it:

WORD POWER A strong definition helps you decide something in a new case.

## Words used in the closer explanation

### Word · Meaning

**Word:** Target population

**Meaning:** The whole collection of cases a question is about

---

**Word:** Sample

**Meaning:** The selected cases used to investigate a larger collection

---

**Word:** Sampling frame

**Meaning:** The list or source from which cases can be selected

---

**Word:** Coverage

**Meaning:** Which relevant kinds of cases the list or sample includes

---

**Word:** Selection bias

**Meaning:** Systematic distortion caused by how cases enter an investigation

---

## 6. Follow a worked example

### WORKED EXAMPLE

#### Watch the Reasoning, Not Just the Answer

Every step connects a claim to observable evidence.



**CASE** An animal recognizer trained only on bright daytime photos may fail on the same animals at night.

**STEP 1 — OBSERVE** example set with represented and absent conditions

**STEP 2 — TRACE** learn patterns from available coverage

**STEP 3 — CONCLUDE** uneven performance across conditions

**MODEL REASONING** The model may rely on bright backgrounds or fail to detect shapes in low light. Collect varied night examples for every relevant animal and preserve a separate night test set to evaluate the repair.

**DO NOT OVERCLAIM** Balance is about useful representation, not forcing every count to be identical without reason.

What new evidence could change this answer?

### A closer explanation

**Plan · What it helps with · Limit to report**

**Plan:** Take cards at the front

**What it helps with:** Quick initial check

**Limit to report:** Front position may restrict conditions

---

**Plan:** Draw from all 24 IDs by chance

**What it helps with:** Every listed card can be selected

**Limit to report:** A small draw need not balance conditions

---

**Plan:** Choose 2 distinct cards per condition

**What it helps with:** Includes all four conditions

**Limit to report:** 8 cards do not establish all 24 outcomes

---

**Plan:** Assess all 24 distinct cards

**What it helps with:** Covers this entire fixed collection

**Limit to report:** Does not prove performance on future images

---

For a broad estimate, a chance-based plan should start from a suitable complete list and use a documented selection procedure. For investigating missing conditions, deliberately selecting cases from each condition can be useful. State which purpose you chose. A set built to expose problems is not automatically a faithful miniature of everyday use.

Selection bias is about a systematic feature of the selection process, not whether a person had bad intentions. Choosing only easy-to-reach, bright cards can leave harder conditions out. More cases from the same narrow source may repeat that gap. A larger sample cannot by itself repair a frame that excludes relevant cases.

## Learn from the worked case

Cover the result before checking it. Say what is given, choose the procedure, and follow one step at a time. Then uncover the result and explain your first mismatch. Ask why a step is allowed, not only what number it produces.

## A pictorial worked case: Missing and Unbalanced Examples

A fictional badge reader will be used in both bright and dim rooms.

### The facts we will use

Intended target has 8 bright plain, 8 bright patterned, 8 dim plain, 8 dim patterned cards.

A development sample contains 6 bright plain cards and 2 bright patterned cards; no dim cards.

## Target groups and development coverage

|                  | Target cards | Sample cards |
|------------------|--------------|--------------|
| Bright plain     | 8            | 6            |
| Bright patterned | 8            | 2            |
| Dim plain        | 8            | 0            |
| Dim patterned    | 8            | 0            |

Read a cell using both its row and column labels.

## Missing and Unbalanced Examples

### Start with the supplied facts

Follow each arrow. Ask which fact allows the next step.



#### 1. Target conditions

Four lighting-by-pattern groups, eight target cards each.



#### 2. Current sample

Eight bright cards only; dim groups have zero coverage.



#### 3. Coverage gap

Current results cannot describe dim-room reading.



#### 4. Targeted follow-up

Select and record new cases from both dim groups before claiming coverage.

### CHANGE ONE THING

Add eight more bright plain cards and no dim cards.

Explain the changed result using the matching lesson.

## Read the picture one step at a time

### Step · What happens and why

**Step:** 1. Target conditions

**What happens and why:** Four lighting-by-pattern groups, eight target cards each.

---

**Step:** 2. Current sample

**What happens and why:** Eight bright cards only; dim groups have zero coverage.

---

### Step: 3. Coverage gap

**What happens and why:** Current results cannot describe dim-room reading.

---

### Step: 4. Targeted follow-up

**What happens and why:** Select and record new cases from both dim groups before claiming coverage.

---

Match each pictured step to the supplied facts. This is a worked teaching case, not an independent assessment.

## Why this result follows

Adding more bright cards can increase sample size without addressing the missing condition. A coverage check asks which relevant situations are absent, not merely how many rows exist. Deliberately selecting dim cases helps investigate those conditions, but the resulting test should not be advertised as a random survey unless its selection really was random.

## What this example does not establish

Coverage does not guarantee accuracy, and targeted cases alone do not supply a population-wide success estimate.

# 7. Find and repair a mistake

COMPARE

## Same Result, Different Reason

A comparison helps reveal the true concept boundary.

### Case · Evidence · What it shows

**Case:** Day photos

**Evidence:** many clear examples

**What it shows:** strong represented condition

---

**Case:** Night photos

**Evidence:** none available

**What it shows:** coverage gap

---

**Case:** Cats 90, dogs 10

**Evidence:** uneven class counts

**What it shows:** class imbalance

---

**Case:** One dog copied 20 times

**Evidence:** count rises, variety does not

**What it shows:** weak repair

---

## Repair two tempting claims

CLAIM A A model can infer missing conditions automatically.

Repair:

CLAIM B Copying rare examples many times creates new variety.

Repair:

STRONG ANSWER FRAME I claim \_\_\_\_\_ because the evidence shows \_\_\_\_\_. The process is \_\_\_\_\_. One limit is \_\_\_\_\_.

## A closer explanation

A careful report identifies the target, frame, selection method, distinct cases, assessed outcomes and gaps. For the original sample: 5 of 6 selected bright-circle cards were correct; the 18 cards in other conditions were not assessed. This is useful evidence with a narrow reach, not a score for all future images.

Even checking all 24 cards answers a question about that fixed collection and that recogniser version. New image sources, different lighting or other shapes introduce new cases. Revisit the target and the coverage plan when the intended use changes.

**A tester collects 100 more bright-circle images and says the absence of dim-square tests no longer matters. Explain what increased and what coverage gap remains**

---

---

---

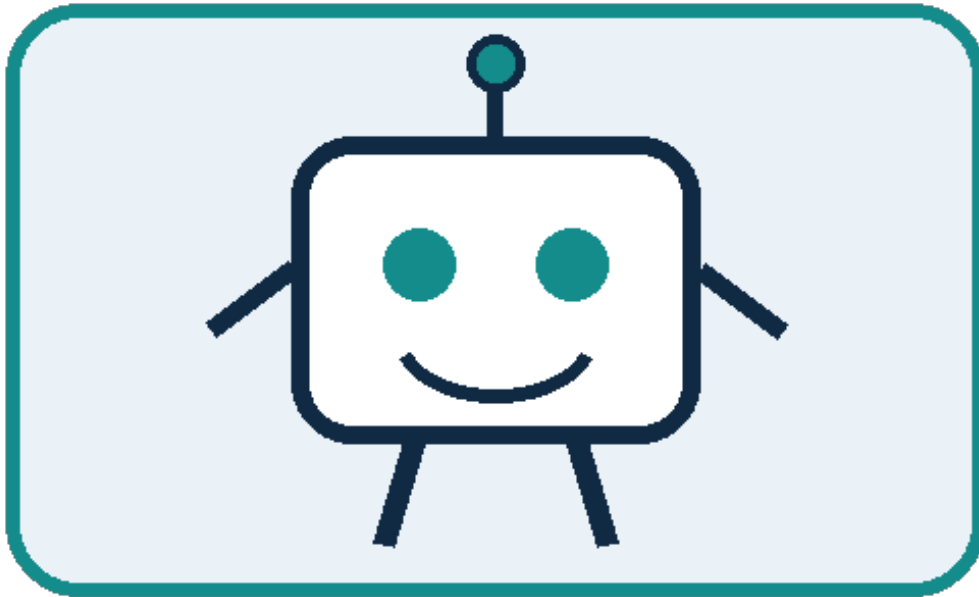
---

## 8. Practise together

### GUIDED PRACTICE

#### Try It, Check It, Explain It

Use support now so you can succeed independently later.



Explain how the picture story demonstrates this idea: What is absent can shape a system's failures.

Use a fresh example to explain missing example.

Trace a new input → process → output example.

Find and repair the error in: Copying rare examples many times creates new variety.

Invent one edge case and name the safe response.

**PARTNER CHECK** Point to the evidence. Do not accept an answer that only repeats the vocabulary word.

### A closer explanation

Imagine a new plan selects 2 distinct cards from each of the four conditions: 8 cards in total. One selected dim-square file cannot be opened. Only 7 have assessed outcomes. Record the missing file and its condition; do not call it a recognition error or pretend all 8 outcomes were checked. This exercise evaluates recognition only, so file availability is reported separately.

**A report says the original recogniser is correct on 5 of 6 cards, so it works on all shapes and lighting. Rewrite the claim using the original sample, identify the three missing conditions, and**

### propose a selection plan to investigate them

---

---

---

---

---

---

---

Choose and document cases before seeing their outcomes. If you use the results to revise the recogniser, keep a separate unseen final test as in Week 15. Coverage and an unseen test solve different problems: one asks which conditions appear; the other asks whether the evaluation cases influenced the revision.

### Practise with less help: Separate files from distinct cases

Use workbook W2 for the connected example “Sampling and coverage”. First fill the input and rule boxes. Try the middle steps before asking for a hint. After a hint, try the next step yourself.

#### Plan · Do · Check

**Plan:** What is given? Which rule or procedure applies?

**Do:** Record each intermediate step.

**Check:** Does the result follow? What remains unknown?

---

Explain your trace to a partner. Your partner points to one step to check. Swap roles on the next case. Each person writes their own explanation.

### Check your reasoning

Use the worked case for Sampling and coverage. Proposed explanation: “More records always remove bias”. Decide whether this explanation is supported. Point to the step or supplied fact that decides; explain your repair if needed.

Answer on your own before discussion. If you are unsure, say which step you need help with.

### Explain the picture

Would testing only dim plain cards close every current gap? Point to the target groups.

#### My explanation using a pictured step and the given facts

---

---

---

---

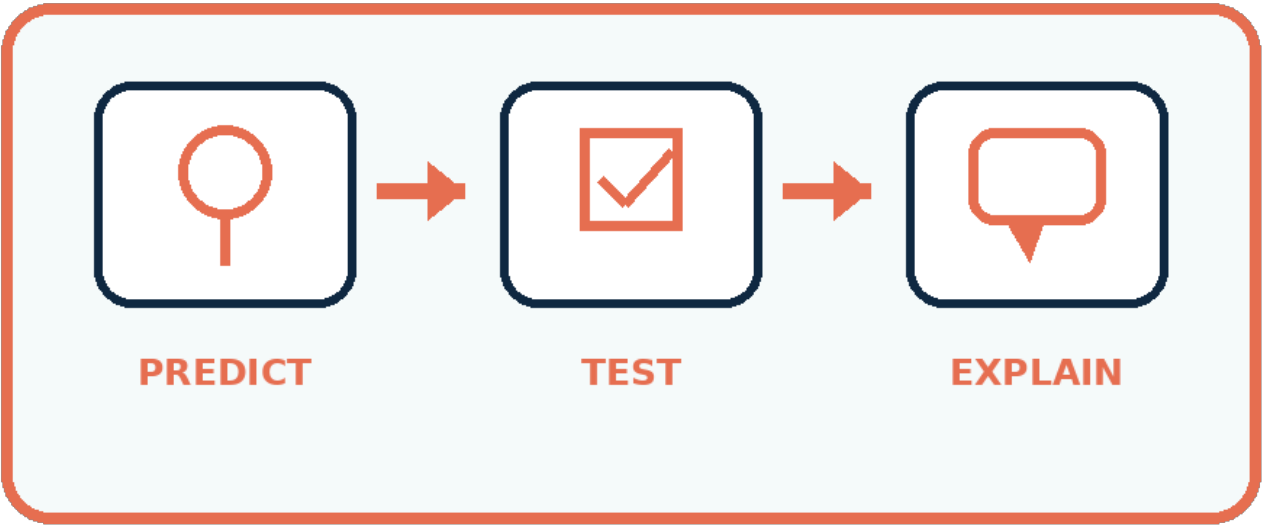
This is supported practice. Keep the separately named independent case for an attempt before feedback.

## 9. Run the investigation

EXPLORER LAB

### Missing-Condition Detective

Predict first, test honestly, and explain what the evidence means.



State your prediction before the result is known.

Complete the task: Predict failures in an animal set missing night photos.

Keep a normal case and an edge case clearly separated.

Record what happened—even when it does not match your prediction.

Explain the result, one limitation, and the next useful test.

#### Case · Prediction · Observed result · What it means

**Case:** Normal

**Prediction:** \_\_\_\_\_

**Observed result:** \_\_\_\_\_

What it means: \_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

Case: Edge

Prediction: \_\_\_\_\_

Observed result: \_\_\_\_\_

What it means: \_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

INDEPENDENCE After support is removed, repeat the proof with a fresh case.

### Plan → try → check

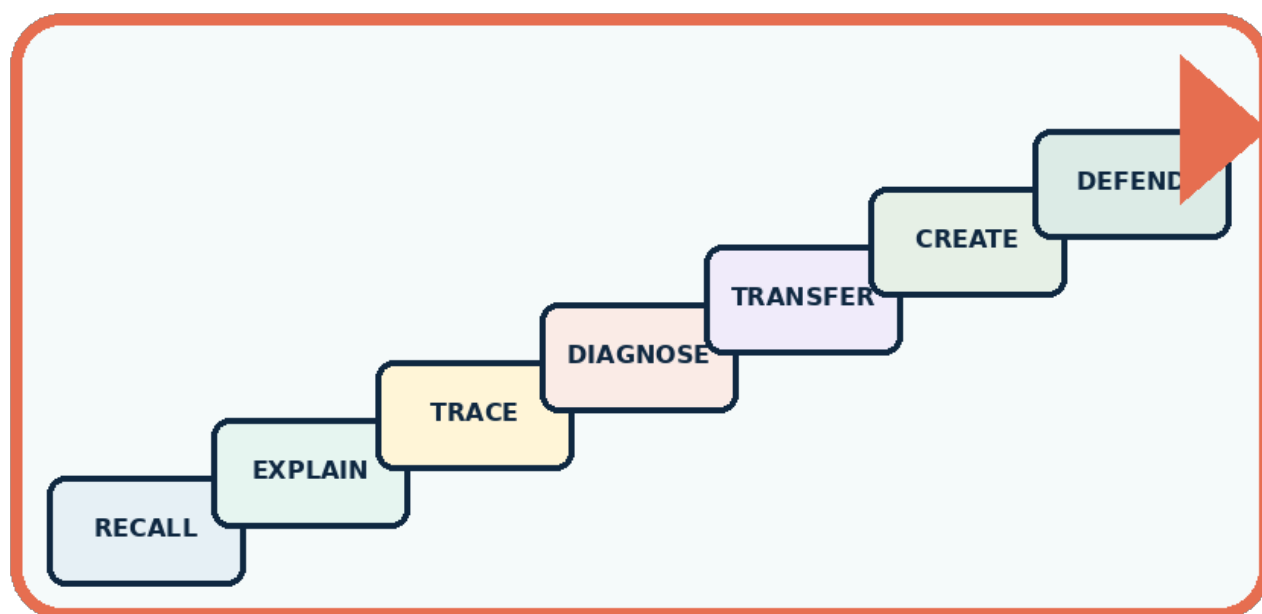
Before trying: what do I expect, and why? While trying: which step could first go wrong? Afterwards: what did I actually observe, and what should change? Keep “not run” if you only traced the procedure.

## 10. Build your understanding

PRACTICE LADDER

### Climb from Recall to Defense

Each step asks for a stronger kind of understanding.



RECALL Define missing example.

EXPLAIN What is absent can shape a system's failures.

**TRACE** Show the input, process, and output.

**DIAGNOSE** Repair: A model can infer missing conditions automatically.

**TRANSFER** Apply the idea to a new home or classroom case.

**CREATE** Design one revealing test.

**DEFEND** Give a claim, evidence, mechanism, limit, and safe action.

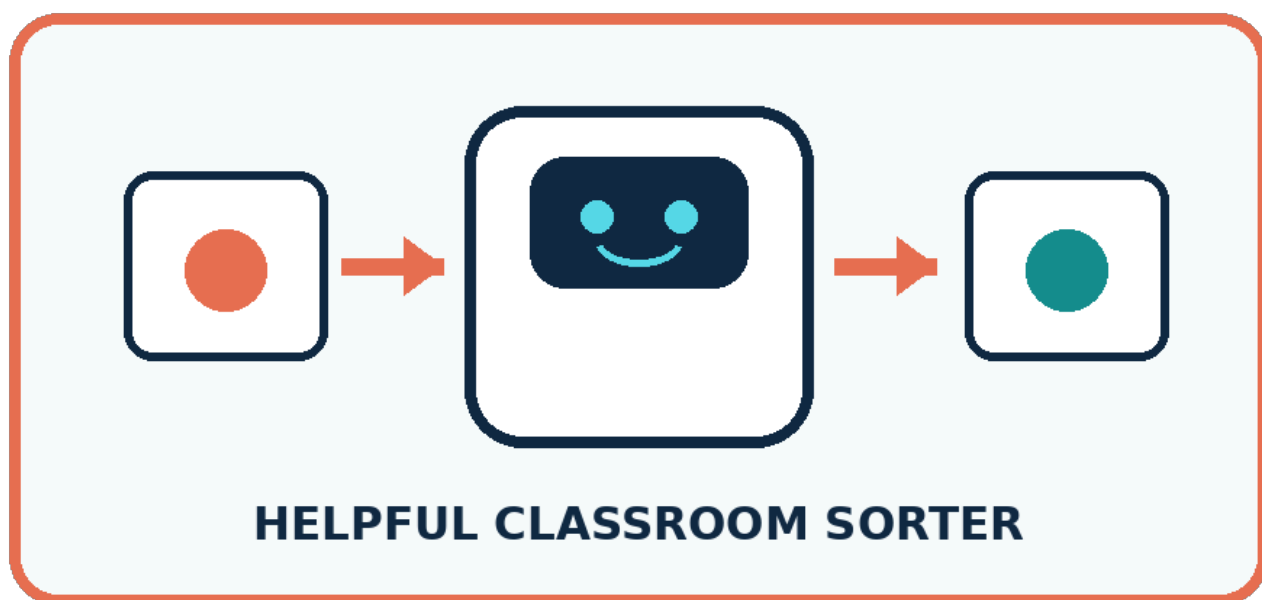
**RETRY RULE** A coached answer becomes mastery only after you solve a different case independently.

## 11. Connect your project

**PROJECT**

### Helpful Classroom Sorter

Build one coherent system across the year, one evidence-based decision at a time.



**THIS WEEK'S CHECKPOINT** List normal, low-light, partly hidden, worn, and unusual items; mark which conditions are missing from the sorter data.

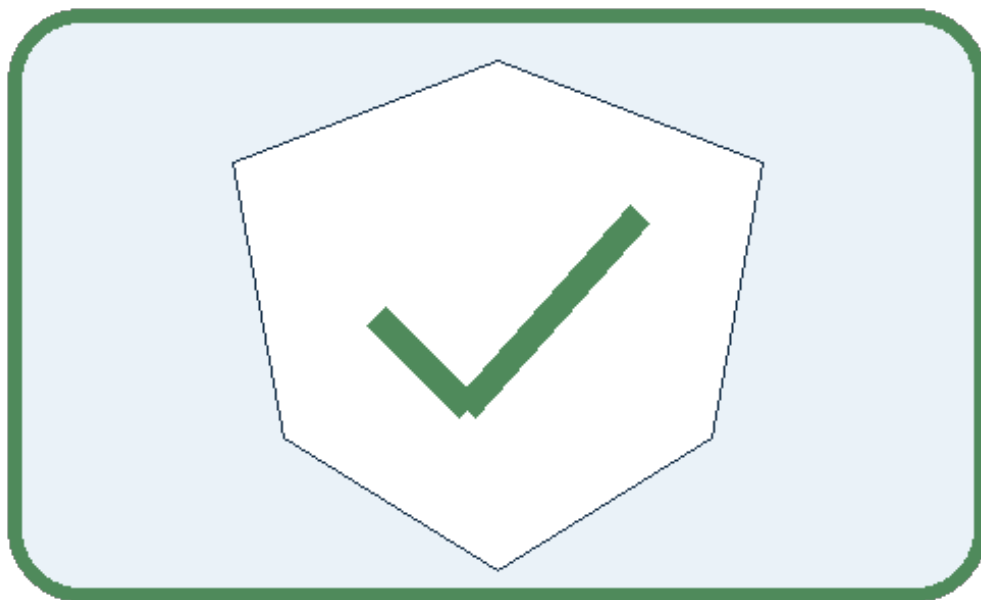
What real classroom need does this serve?

What information is necessary—and what should stay private?

What happens inside the process?

What normal and edge cases will you test?

When should it say not sure or ask a person?



RESPONSIBLE DESIGN Balance is about useful representation, not forcing every count to be identical without reason.

My project decision:

### **Evidence for your project**

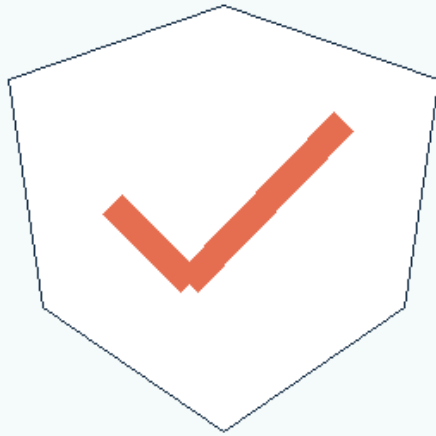
Create a sorter coverage table crossing important classroom conditions, then state which groups each test actually represents.

## **12. Show what you know**

MASTERY

### **Fresh-Case Independent Proof**

Complete this after teaching and guided practice have ended.



## INDEPENDENT PROOF

**REQUIRED PROOF** Predict failures in an animal set missing night photos and propose a targeted data repair.

- ☐ Name or draw the fresh case.
- ☐ Trace input, process, and output.
- ☐ State the conclusion and strongest evidence.
- ☐ Name one limit, failure, missing clue, or fairness/privacy concern.
- ☐ Explain one safe next action or improvement.

Independent evidence:

**SELF-CHECK** The model may rely on bright backgrounds or fail to detect shapes in low light. Collect varied night examples for every relevant animal and preserve a separate night test set to evaluate the repair.

My level: ☐ Not yet ☐ With one hint ☐ Independently ☐ I can teach it

**NEXT BRIDGE** Carry today's evidence habit into: Fair for Whom?.

## 13. Study a complete case

### Week 22 Worked case

Use the supplied details to practise the weekly concept before attempting the independent question. This

case extends the illustrated lesson.

**The situation**

Training includes nine daylight leaf photos and one low-light photo.

**The question**

What intended-use gap is present?

**Worked explanation**

Low light is poorly represented. Add varied, correctly labelled low-light examples if that use is intended. Copies of one photo do not add equivalent variety.

**Explain it in your own words**

Which detail supports the answer, and why does it matter?

**Write or draw your reasoning and evidence.**

---

---

---

---

---

**Trace the supplied case visually**

**Training examples can leave gaps**

**Evidence or stage · Value or result**

**Evidence or stage:** Daylight photos

**Value or result:** 9

---

**Evidence or stage:** Low-light photos

**Value or result:** 1

---

Training includes nine daylight leaf photos and one low-light photo.

What intended-use gap is present?

Low light is poorly represented. Add varied, correctly labelled low-light examples if that use is intended.  
Copies of one photo do not add equivalent variety.

# 14. Try a new case independently

## Independent case: Audit a new sound-recognition claim

A fixed target has 20 invented clips: 5 quiet bells, 5 noisy bells, 5 quiet claps and 5 noisy claps. A tester selects 4 distinct quiet bells from a quiet-bell-only list; 3 are correctly labelled and 1 is wrong. Write a supported result, name missing conditions and explain why the result is not established for all 20 clips. Propose an 8-clip plan that includes every condition, with no clip selected twice.

### My independent explanation, trace and limits

---

---

---

---

---

---

---

Attempt this case before feedback. Record any help. Earlier examples below are further practice; a case already practised with feedback cannot establish fresh transfer.

## Week 22 Independent application

Close the worked explanation. Apply the idea to this different question without copying.

A photo sorter trains on ten bright photos and no dim photos. What group of examples is missing? Design a test that reveals the gap.

My answer, with a trace, calculation or supporting evidence

### Write or draw your reasoning and evidence.

---

---

---

---

---

## Create and test

Change one relevant detail. Predict the result before testing. Include a boundary or missing-information case when it helps reveal a limit.

My changed input and expected result

**Write or draw your reasoning and evidence.**

---

---

---

---

---

## Connect to your project

List normal, low-light, partly hidden, worn, and unusual items; mark which conditions are missing from the sorter data.

The evidence I will keep

**Write or draw your reasoning and evidence.**

---

---

---

---

---

Your teacher has the independent answer and scoring criteria. Complete the matching workbook week to keep your practice evidence together.

## Transfer practice from the original programme

A training set has 18 daylight photos and two dark photos of one object. Copying the dark photos eight times balances the counts. Does it balance the variety? Design a better collection step.

**Explain the mechanism, evidence and one limit.**

---

---

---

---

---

---

---

**Use feedback to improve**

Attempt the independent case before hints. Record whether you worked alone, used a hint or followed a model. After feedback, fix the first unsupported step and explain why it changed. A later check uses a changed case, not a copied answer.